

Legitimate Interests Assessment (LIA)

Our internal assessment of why we may rely on legitimate interests as the lawful basis for sharing property-tax enquiry data with a specialist partner firm. A standing assessment, prepared in line with the ICO's legitimate interests guidance. It is our own record and is not specific to any one partner firm.

Controller carrying out this assessment	Ashfield Trading Limited (company number 16358723), trading as Property Tax Partners ("we" / "the Supplier")
Completed by	Mohammed Junayd Moughal, Director
Date	22 June 2026
Review date	22 June 2027, or earlier on any material change to the sharing, the data, the lawful basis or the law
Processing assessed	Sharing the personal data of people who submit a property-tax enquiry through our website with a specialist accountancy and tax firm to which we refer enquiries under a written data sharing agreement (the "Partner Firm"), so that the Partner Firm can respond to and advise the enquirer. An independent controller-to-controller share, one direction only.
Lawful basis assessed	Legitimate interests, Article 6(1)(f) UK GDPR, relied on together with Article 6(1)(b) (steps taken at the request of the data subject) where the sharing is necessary to act on the enquiry
Personal data involved	The enquirer's name; email address and/or telephone number; and any free-text enquiry message they choose to provide (which may include their property and tax circumstances). No special category data is intended to be collected or shared.
Scope	A standing assessment covering our referral of property-tax enquiries to any Partner Firm that meets the criteria in section 1.4. The identity of the Partner Firm in each case is recorded in the applicable data sharing agreement and disclosed to the enquirer in our transparency information.

Part 1 - Purpose test (is there a legitimate interest?)

1.1 What is the purpose of the processing? To connect a person who has asked, through our website, for specialist property-tax help with a specialist firm (the Partner Firm) that can answer their enquiry, and to operate a lead-referral arrangement with that firm.

1.2 What benefit do we expect, and for whom?

- For the enquirer: a prompt response and specialist advice on the property-tax matter they asked about, which is the outcome they were seeking.
- For us and for the Partner Firm: a legitimate commercial benefit from operating a lead-referral arrangement (we are remunerated for qualifying enquiries we refer).
- More widely: efficient matching of people who need specialist tax help with a firm that provides it.

1.3 Are these interests legitimate? Yes. Both a commercial interest in a lead-referral arrangement and the interest in responding to a person's request for help are recognised legitimate interests. They are real and specific, not speculative.

1.4 Is the processing lawful, and what must the Partner Firm be? The data is ordinary contact and enquiry data, not special category data. In each case the Partner Firm is a reputable and appropriately regulated or professionally qualified specialist firm, engaged under a written controller-to-controller data sharing agreement, and named to the enquirer in our transparency information. The Partner Firm's first

contact is a response to the enquiry, not direct marketing; neither party carries out other electronic marketing without a lawful basis under PECR.

Part 2 - Necessity test (is the processing necessary?)

2.1 Does sharing the data actually achieve the purpose? Yes. The Partner Firm cannot respond to or advise the enquirer without the enquirer's contact details and a description of their enquiry. Sharing those details is what enables the enquiry to be answered.

2.2 Is it a reasonable and proportionate way to achieve the purpose? Yes. We share only the minimum personal data needed (the enquirer's name, their email and/or phone number, and any message they chose to write), with a single recipient (the Partner Firm), in one direction only.

2.3 Is there a less intrusive way to achieve the same result? No realistic one. The enquirer came to our website specifically to be put in touch with property-tax help; the only way to deliver that is to pass their contact details to the specialist firm so it can make contact. Sharing less would prevent the Partner Firm from responding.

Part 3 - Balancing test (do the individual's interests override?)

3.1 Nature of the data. Ordinary identification and contact data, plus a free-text enquiry that may include the enquirer's property and tax circumstances. It is not special category data and not criminal-offence data. The service is aimed at adults seeking tax advice, not children. We design the enquiry form to avoid special category data and to minimise free-text sensitive detail.

3.2 Reasonable expectations. The enquirer actively completes and submits an enquiry seeking specialist property-tax help and expects to be contacted as a result. At the point of submission we tell them, in plain language, that their details will be shared with our specialist partner firm (named in the notice), an independent controller that will contact them, with a link to that firm's privacy policy. Sharing their details with that firm is therefore squarely within their reasonable expectations.

3.3 Likely impact on the individual. Low, and positive. They receive a response from a specialist firm about the matter they raised, which is what they asked for. The data is not used for unrelated purposes; the Partner Firm's first contact is a response, not marketing; we and the Partner Firm each retain the data only as long as needed (we delete or anonymise our copy within 3 months of referring it); and the transfer is made by a secure method (encrypted in transit).

3.4 Would the individual object, and can they? Most enquirers are unlikely to object, having asked to be contacted. Even so, we tell them of, and provide a route to exercise, the right to object under Article 21, and we will not share (or will stop sharing) where a person objects, withdraws any consent relied on, or where the required basis is absent. We and the Partner Firm each maintain a suppression list and tell the other promptly of any objection or opt-out.

3.5 Safeguards in place to reduce any impact.

- Transparency: a clear notice at the point of collection naming the actual Partner Firm, plus a privacy notice naming that firm as a recipient and explaining the share, with a link to its privacy policy.
- Data minimisation: only name, contact details and any optional message are shared; no special category data.
- One recipient, one direction.
- The right to object and to withdraw, honoured by both parties.
- Secure transfer (encrypted in transit) and access controls.
- Short retention (we delete or anonymise within 3 months; the Partner Firm keeps only as long as necessary for the enquiry or its engagement).

- A written controller-to-controller data sharing agreement allocating each party's responsibilities, with the Partner Firm a reputable, appropriately regulated specialist firm.
- Where we refer to more than one Partner Firm, the same safeguards apply to each, and the enquirer is told which firm will receive their data.

Outcome

Having weighed our (and the Partner Firm's) legitimate interests against the interests, rights and freedoms of the enquirer, and taking account of the safeguards above, we are satisfied that:

- there is a genuine legitimate interest;
- the sharing is necessary for that interest; and
- that interest is not overridden by the enquirer's interests, rights or freedoms.

Legitimate interests under Article 6(1)(f) UK GDPR (relied on with Article 6(1)(b) where applicable) is an appropriate lawful basis for referring property-tax enquiries to a Partner Firm meeting the criteria in section 1.4, with the safeguards above. We will keep this assessment under review and repeat it at least annually, and sooner if we begin sharing with a materially different type of recipient, or if the data, the lawful basis or the law materially changes.

Signed: MJ Moughal

Name: Mohammed Junayd Moughal, Director, Ashfield Trading Limited (trading as Property Tax Partners)

Date: 22 June 2026